

Subject: Instructions: Setting up R in Jupyter Lab

Date: Monday, March 2, 2026 at 12:37:01 PM Mountain Standard Time

From: Jeremy Hogeveen

To: Jeremy Hogeveen

CC: Geni Stainbrook, Brandon Jackson, Megan Gayle Santos, Westin Jones, Eunice Kim, Maya Marquez Garcia, Katie Edwards, Sophia Lipetzky, Max Segal, Mikayla Poe, Anh Tang, Kylie Wooden, Valeria Torres Ramos, Mark Lavelle

Hi Class,

The next sections of the class we will be getting some experience using the R programming language, which I find particularly helpful for statistical computing.

To make this work while staying in our `dspn_env` & Jupyter-Lab, you will have to do a few things outlined in this email (**opt 1**). If you'd like to go with the fallback option of just downloading and using R on its own, that is outlined here as well (**opt 2**).

I will plan on spending some time going over this process at the start of class tomorrow, just to make sure we're all up and running, but if you want to come prepared ahead of time here are the step-by-step instructions.

—

Opt 1: adding an R kernel for Jupyter lab.

1. In Terminal / Git Bash / Conda prompt (whichever you're using for the class!) activate our class environment:

```
conda activate dspn_env
```

2. Install R and the Jupyter R-kernel package:

```
conda install -c conda-forge r-base r-irkernel
```

(Note: Type 'y' and press Enter if Conda prompts you to proceed)

3. Launch R within the terminal by typing:

```
R
```

4. Tell Jupyter where to find this new R installation by running this command exactly as written inside the R prompt:

```
IRkernel::installspec(name = 'ir_dspn_env', displayname = 'R  
(conda env)')
```

5. Quit the R prompt by typing:

```
q()
```

(Note: You can answer 'n' if it asks to save your workspace image)

6. Finally, launch Jupyter Lab as usual:

jupyter lab

(Note: now you should have an R kernel option when setting up a new notebook in Jupyter lab!)

—

Opt 2: installing standard R + Studio combo.

If you're having trouble with conda, feel free to just go ahead and install R and R Studio manually using the GUI installers. You would need to manually copy and paste coursework into these coding environments, but that shouldn't be too challenging to do lots of folks have used this path in previous course iterations.

1. Download and install R here: <https://cran.r-project.org/>
2. Download and install R Studio Desktop here: <https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop/>

—

Let me know if you run into any trouble getting this all set u. See you tomorrow!

Cheers,
Jeremy

Jeremy Hogeveen, PhD
(he/him/his)
Associate Professor
Department of Psychology
University of New Mexico
[Google Scholar](#) / [Lab Website](#)
Phone: 773-941-2182